GED 3402 Music in Western Civilization
Assignment Guidelines

A. Attendance and Participation 20%

Physical presence, participate in discussion.

B. Assignment I: Listening Report 40% 1,500 words

1. Choose one or several pieces of music within the topics of this course, i.e. Medieval to Contemporary.
2. Do an online research on the style period, the composer, the background and the influences of *the work(s)*.
3. Listen to the music referring to the information that you have obtained.
4. Comment on the listening e.g. the musical style, the composer's characteristics, the instruments used, etc. You may also include the background of the performers, the interpretation and the performing standard.

C. Final Paper 40% 1,500 words

1. Pick a *style period* that interests you the most, say Medieval, Renaissance, Baroque, Classical, Romantic, Impressionism, Russian and Pop.
2. Find a musical genre in that Period to work on, e.g. *The Italian Opera in the Romantic Period; The Classical Symphonies; The Music of Impressionism*, etc.
3. If you find the above topics too big, further narrowing down to choose a composer and some music from that composer OR even one piece of music, e.g. *Mozart's Piano Sonatas, Mozart's Symphony No.41, Beethoven's Symphony No.9 'Ode to Joy', Puccini's Opera Madam Butterfly*, etc.
4. The details can be as follows if the topic is *Beethoven's 9th Symphony* (1,500 words)
   a) Introduction: give a very brief introduction of Beethoven's biography and his period, i.e. Classical Period. (within 250 words)
   b) Under what circumstance did Beethoven write the 9th Symphony, who is the lyricist and a short introduction for this lyricist? (250 words)
   c) Give the details of the Symphony: the movements, the year he wrote and premiere, the immediate response. (250 words)
   d) Your own comment: which performance (orchestra and conductor, CD or

youtube or qq)? Do you like it or not? Why? Which particular movement or all four movements? (500 words)

e) After Beethoven died, this Symphony enjoys its popularity worldwide including China. Why? (250 words)
f) Anything you want to discuss further, e.g. the general feeling every time you listen to this piece.

the above arrangement allows you to gather some facts and background and REWRITE it, DO NOT COPY & PASTE! **Copy and paste without citing the source is plagiarism! You may further discuss it and then make your own judgement.

5. You can choose a topic relating to the modern society:
   a) *The importance of classical music activities* (such as concert, opera) in China or in Shenzhen since there are so many concert halls and opera houses.
   b) After attending my lectures of western music in chronological order, do you want to *plan a music festival for Shenzhen* or for your own town? What kind of programmes will attract the people there? Or you plan an Opera Festival, what kind of programme? E.g. Option 1: a 2-3 weeks International Music Festival with 3 evenings of opera Turandot, 3 evenings of a world-famous symphony orchestra, a string quartet and a pianist. Option 2: a Beethoven Festival of 2 weeks, etc.
   c) Do you want to derive *an educational plan for children* (or can be adults) to appreciate western classical music?

6. My last lecture of this term will be *Western Pop Music and Broadway Musical*. You can pick any musical to write along the guideline of Item 4 above.
7. You may go a bit philosophical to examine *the value of music in a modern society* with examples taken from western classical or pop music.
8. Must include a list of *bibliography.*

You can discuss with me your intended topic via the group wechat or wechat me separately (CWWmusic). You can also email me at cww.music@gmail.com